



BETAMETHASONE CREAM

MAL19890514AZ

COMPOSITION:

Betamethasone 17-Valerate (micronised)
equivalent to Betamethasone 0.1% w/w

Chlorocresol 0.1% w/w as preservative.

PRESENTATION:

A smooth, white, water-miscible cream.

INDICATIONS:

For the treatment of eczema, including atopic, infantile, discoid and stasis eczema; prurigo; psoriasis; neurodermatoses, including lichen simplex; lichen planus; seborrheic dermatitis; intertrigo; contact sensitivity reactions; discoid lupus erythematosus; generalised erythroderma; insect bites; otitis externa.

PHARMACOLOGY:

Mechanism of Action:

Betamethasone 17-valerate, a synthetic glucocorticoid, is thought to act by controlling the rate of synthesis of protein. It reacts with receptor proteins in the cytoplasm of sensitive cells to form a steroid-receptor complex which undergoes a conformational change.

DIRECTION FOR USE:

Apply small quantity to the affected skin 2 or 3 times daily until improvement occurs. It may then be possible to maintain improvement by applying once a day, or even less often. In the more resistant lesions such as the thickened plaques of psoriasis on elbows and knees, the effect of the preparation can be enhanced by occluding overnight the treatment area with polythene film; thereafter improvement can be maintained by regular application without occlusion.

CONTRAINDICATION:

Rosacea, acne and peri-oral dermatitis. Skin lesions caused by infection with viruses (e.g. *herpes simplex*, *chickenpox*), fungi (e.g. *candidiasis*, *tinea*) or bacteria (e.g. *impetigo*).

PRECAUTION:

Long-term continuous topical therapy should be avoided where possible, particularly in infants and children. The face, more than other areas of the body, may exhibit atrophic changes after prolonged treatment. Application to the eyelids may cause glaucoma. Any spread of infection requires withdrawal of the product and systemic administration of antimicrobial agents. Avoid extensive use in pregnancy.

SIDE EFFECTS:

Prolonged and intensive treatment may cause local atopic changes in the skin such as striae, thinning, and dilatation of the superficial blood vessels, particularly when occlusive dressings are used or when skin folds are involved. Prolonged use of large amounts, or treatment of extensive areas can result in sufficient systemic absorption to produce the features of hypercorticism, and is more likely to occur in infants and children or if occlusive dressings (or napkin) are used. In rare instances, treatment of psoriasis (or its withdrawal) is thought to have provoked the pustular form of the disease. Betamethasone is usually well tolerated, but if signs of hypersensitivity appear, therapy should stop immediately.

OVERDOSAGE & TREATMENTS:

Toxic effects are nearly always signs of overdosage and should be treated symptomatically, and dosages reduced or the drug slowly withdrawn. During prolonged treatment, laboratory and metabolic studies should be made; measurement of the fluid intake and output, and daily weight record, may give early warning of fluid retention. Sodium intake may need to be reduced to less than 1g daily and potassium supplements may be necessary.

STORAGE:

Keep container well closed. Store below 30°C. Protect from light.

KEEP OUT OF REACH OF CHILDREN JAUHI DARI KANAK-KANAK

PACK QUANTITIES:

Available in aluminium tube of 5gm and 15gm.

Further information can be obtained from pharmacist, physician or the manufacturer.

Product Registration Holder & Manufactured By:

 **Kotra Pharma (M) Sdn. Bhd.**
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